

Reader: Presentation of Action Plans

Session 04 does not introduce new sustainability content. It is where the three previous sessions come together in your own **ESD Action Plan**. This reader is shorter than the others on purpose: it is a guide to finishing a strong Action Plan and presenting it well, not a new set of concepts to learn. Also available as a downloadable PDF.

What the Action Plan is actually made of

By this session, your Action Plan already has three parts, one from each of the previous sessions, and this session asks you to bring them together into a single short presentation:

1. **From Session 01:** a review of how sustainable development currently shows up (or doesn't) in your own teaching content and syllabi, using the dimensions, frameworks, and historical grounding covered there as your reference points.
2. **From Session 02:** the concrete opportunities you identified to bring SD into your course, framed through the SDGs, Agenda 2063, or another relevant framework, and articulated through your own discipline's specific links to sustainability.
3. **From Session 03:** a fully developed lesson or session built with constructive alignment, at least three learning outcomes, learning activities that actively engage students with those outcomes, and an assessment format that actually measures them.

If you want a refresher on any of these before presenting, the Session 01, Session 02, and Session 03 readers cover them in depth, including the textbook links for Sessions 01 and 02.

Presenting in six minutes

The presentation itself is short by design, roughly six minutes per participant or group, so it works best as a structured walk-through rather than a comprehensive account. The slides suggest covering, in order: your current state (what you found in the Session 1 review), the opportunities and gaps you identified (Session 2), and the developed lesson itself (Session 3), naming its three learning outcomes, the learning activities that support them, and how you would assess them. Resist the pull to spend most of the six minutes on background and context, the constructive-alignment design is the part your listeners are there to react to and give feedback on.

Giving useful peer feedback

Listeners are asked to take notes and prepare constructive feedback while others present. Because action plans span many different disciplines, the most useful feedback usually isn't "does this work well within its own field," but rather **whether and how a presented idea could translate into a different field**. A constructive-alignment design built for a hydrology course and one built for a literature course rarely transfer directly, but the underlying moves (a clearer learning outcome, a more active learning activity, a better-aligned assessment) usually do. Framing feedback this way is also what turns individual presentations into the basis for the collaboration discussion that follows.

From presentations to collaboration

After the presentations, the session moves to a synthesis of the key insights that came up (recurring challenges, and where people said they need more support), followed by a structured discussion of collaboration opportunities: with other lecturers, other departments, or organisations outside academia already working on sustainability initiatives. This is where the cross-disciplinary variety of the Action Plans becomes an asset rather than a complication, the differences between disciplines are exactly what make collaboration worth pursuing, rather than everyone independently reinventing similar material.

Closing the course

The course closes with an open reflection on the main learnings from across all four sessions, followed by a course evaluation. Since this pilot course has been delivered in different formats (fully live, self-paced online, and hybrid, across the Kenyan and Ethiopian cohorts), the evaluation should be read and adapted with that specific delivery context in mind, what worked in a live, in-person setting will not always transfer directly to a self-paced asynchronous one, and vice versa.

Part of Integrating Sustainability into Higher Education: Theories, Concepts, and Practical Strategies, an Open Educational Resource co-developed by the Centre for Development and Environment (CDE), University of Bern, together with the University of Nairobi (Department of Geography, Population and Environmental Studies), the Centre for Training and Integrated Research on ASAL Development (CETRAD), Addis Ababa University (College of Education and Behavioral Studies), and the Water and Land Resource Centre (WLRC). Licensed under CC BY-NC-SA 4.0. Full course: https://cdeteaching.github.io/IntegrateSustainabilityIntoHigherEducation_pilotcourse